Sibs

By Diane Flacks and Richard Greenblatt

(Packing for trip to parent's funeral, they complain out loud about the other) – Separate locations

SHE: **(Pg 6-7)** We always have to do things his way, I mean always!

HE: She always has to be the centre of attention.

SHE: I can tell he's always seeking my approval, because, frankly he lives his life in a way that is less interesting than he could, and then he starts judging me, and I do just fine thanks for asking!

HE: She really is a very interesting person, it's just that sometimes she can't help herself from saying the wrong thing at the wrong time and basically she just doesn't know when to shut up!

SHE: [When we were teenagers] he took up all my space in the car and then he farted and left it there! And then he scratches his *butt* and he puts his fingers in my hair!

HE: . . . she always had to have like ***these*** new jeans or she always had to have ***those*** new jeans and it didn't even matter which new jeans she had because her *butt* was still like 8 feet wide!

SHE: I take care of everything and I don't say a word and the minute he lifts a finger, we all have to bow down.

HE: When the going gets tough, she takes off. Maybe I'm a little slow, but I've finally come to realize ... you can't change a person.

SHE: Well, you can't change.

BOTH: *(simultaneously)* I'm really worried about her/him.

SHE: He is not happy, and he thinks he has to follow this path that just leads to disappointment - I mean, live your life!

HE: If she keeps on going in this way she won't have anything saved for her retirement, I mean, she can't work forever, what's she gonna do?

BOTH: *(simultaneously)* And s/he has terrible taste in women.

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INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS: *To the outside world we all grow old. But not brothers and sisters.*
ACTOR: *We know each other as we always were. We know each other's hearts.*
ACTRESS: *We share private family jokes. We remember family feuds and secrets, family griefs and joys.*
TOGETHER: *We live outside the touch of time.*
ACTOR: *After the death of their parents these two adult siblings must put their differences aside*
ACTRESS: *And realize that no matter what the circumstance -- what distance lies between them -- they will always be*
TOGETHER: *Sibs by Diane Flacks and Richard Greenblatt*

(On Phone)

HE: **(Pg 10 - 12)** I just thought . . . that because there's a whole bunch of stuff to do, and because some of it is time sensitive, right? Some of it has to be done right now. Well, some of it is legal stuff, right? Lawyer stuff, the death certificate, getting the will probated -- that kind of stuff, right?

SHE: Right, but I don't have to just sit here in the city. Some of these things just happen --

HE: No they have to be dealt with -- somebody has to be in charge. Somebody has to make sure that they're done, right?

SHE: Right. And you don't want to do it. **HE:** Well -- I --

SHE: Well, let's do it long distance. **HE:** No uh --

SHE: You know what, I'll do it? Give me the number -- **HE:** Excuse me-

SHE: I'll get the number from the lawyer and I'll just handle it all long distance. You don't have to do it. I understand, you're busy.

(Scene transition and they are now little kids)

SHE: Do you want to play with *Play-Dough*? *(NOTE: script uses the term "plasticine")*

HE: Yeah.

SHE: Do you know where my *Play-Dough* is? **HE:** Yeah.

SHE: It's in my room. In my closet! GO! Go! Go go go go go! *(HE runs up the stairs to her room and gets it. They play for a few seconds)* What are you making? A snake? A bone?

HE: Mommy.

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SHE: I'm making mommy too. Isn't mine good? **HE:** Yeah.

SHE: Yours is good . . . too. *(They work a bit)* Hey! Can you get me a drink?

HE: Yeah.

SHE: Go! go go go go go go go go go go! *(HE runs to go get it, but is gone a long while; SHE has "fixed" his Mommy; after a pause she yells)* Where are you?

HE: In the kitchen! **SHE:** Come here with the drink!

HE: *(beat)* Oh yeah! *(HE sees his "mommy." HE is upset)*

SHE: I fixed it. Your mommy looked like a bug. *(He smashes both of their sculptures)*

SHE: What are you doing?!

BOTH: Mommy! Mommy!

(Scene transition – still kids – Scene opens with SHE tickling HE)

HE: **(Pg 18-19)** Stop it I have to pee! **SHE:** Don't pee!

HE: Don't do that. **SHE:** Pssss.

HE: Stop it! **SHE:** Pss psss pssss.

HE: No no stop stop. *(silent beat)* Oh no!! I peed! I peed!

SHE: You peed! You peed! **I** made you pee!! *(SHE throws her arms up, victorious Her laugh becomes the laugh of a drunk teen. SHE turns and starts to walk away)*

(Scene transition – teenagers)

SHE: You peed. I made you pee, mister. **HE:** Shh. You'll wake up Mom and Dad.

SHE: You peed. I made you pee.

HE: That's good. Now, come on, let's get you upstairs. *(HE tries to help her up)*

SHE: You smell like . . . potatoes.

HE: We've got to get you upstairs before Mom and Dad hear. **(Pg 20)** God. You're disgusting.

SHE: ***You're*** disgusting . . . **(Pg 21)** Spinning. **HE:** Are you going to barf?

SHE: No. *(SHE barfs)* **HE:** Ewwww!!

(Scene transition – still teenagers –his fantasy rehearsal of how he would ask her for advice. HE and SHE face the audience)

HE: **(Pg 23-24)** Can I ask you a question? **SHE:** I don't know, can you?

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HE: There's this dance tonight, and I wanted to know, if you're slow dancing with a girl is it o.k.

SHE: Yuck! Ick! Gross! Disgusting! *(HE waves away that attempt and tries another)*

HE: Can I ask you a question? **SHE:** Sure.

HE: Say, hypothetically, I was slow dancing with a girl-

SHE: Who?! **HE:** Well, it doesn't matter who.

SHE: Rochelle? **HE:** No, not Rochelle.

SHE: Oooh, Rochelle. Rochellllle! *(HE waves away that attempt and tries another)*

HE: I have this friend -- **SHE:** Who?

HE: Uh. . . Todd. **SHE:** Yich.

HE: Yeah. Well, he wanted me to ask you, if he's slow dancing with a girl --

SHE: Who?! **HE:** Oh, I can't say. I promised.

SHE: Rochelle? **HE:** No! Todd doesn't like Rochelle.

SHE: No, but Rochelle likes Todd ... *(HE waves away that attempt and tries another)*

HE: Can I ask you a question!? **SHE:** Yes!

HE: Todd wanted me to ask you if he's slow dancing with a girl, is it o.k. if I kiss him!?

SHE: I think you should kiss him.

(Scene transition – still teenagers)

SHE: **(Pg 25-26)** Are you going to that dance tonight? **HE:** Yeah.

SHE: Well, what are you gonna wear? **HE:** What I always wear.

SHE: Oh no. You're not! **HE:** Why not?

SHE: Because you look like a jock. **HE:** I am a jock.

SHE: I know, but you smell like a jock. I mean, literally. A jock. And your shoes stink, and your socks reek, and your pants smell like skid marks and stale farts and you stink like BO, and you have this stink coming off you, it's like a stinky rank stank, skunky funky funk stinky stink stank rank skank skanky stinkudee skunk stank! *(beat)* I mean you really do smell-

HE: Alright! OK! *(Pause. SHE looks at him)* **SHE:** Hey, stinky,

HE: What? **SHE:** Can I ask you a question?

HE: **(Pg 33-34)** *(suspiciously)* Yeah . . .

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SHE: Can you come here for a second? OK. Say you don't know me. And say you saw me walking on the street - could you look straight ahead please? Would you think I was cool or a loser? Straight ahead, please. *(SHE walks)*

HE: ... Cool.

SHE: Yeah? OK, say you don't know me, and you just saw me -- look straight ahead -- walking down the street, would you think I had a walk of self-confidence or not? Straight ahead, thank you. *(SHE walks)*

HE: Self ... self-confident.

SHE: Yeah? I think I'm ready.

(Scene transition -- As adults after their parents' funeral)

HE: **(Pg 27)** So, all I would like, if possible, is for you to stay a few more days. We can get started on it, and then you can go back home --

SHE: I need to get home now --

HE: What's the soonest you can get back?

SHE: I don't know

HE: You don't know???

SHE: No, I don't know because this is all new to me. This is all new information to me

HE: Well, this is all new to me too – new information that you're leaving

SHE: I don't live in this city.

HE: As far as I knew you were staying until Thursday.

SHE: Where'd you get that information.

HE: You.

SHE: I don't think so. **(Pg 30)** *(reality bubble as teens, she slaps his face)* You lie you lie you lie!

(Scene transition -- As teenagers)

HE: **(Pg 31-32)** Yeah, right

SHE: *(imitating him exactly)* Yeah, right

HE: Fine

SHE: Fine

HE: Stop that.

SHE: Stop that. *(they become little kids)*

HE: Stop copying me!

SHE: Stop copying me!

HE: Mom, she's copying me!

SHE: Mom, she's copying . . . *(he smacks her)*

(Scene transition – They gasp, back as adults after their parents' funeral

HE: **(Pg 62-65)** Fine. . .Then you go home --

SHE: I need to go home!

HE: -- and I will do it *all* !!! *(beat)*

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SHE: You've got your family and your kids --- you've got everything here, and do you know I've been here alone? Do you know that? I've been here alone this whole time. You always had your family to go home to and all these people here to talk to who know you. My whole life is in another city. I can't stay here any more. I've been completely alone! Thank you! *(long pause)*

HE: I think Rochelle and I are splitting up. *(beat)* I don't have anybody to go home and talk to. And I'm sorry that you're not at home and you don't have all of your "support systems" and that kind of stuff, but I'm under stress as well. *(SHE says nothing)* I just thought that we could spend some time together. *(SHE gives him a sharp look)* This is a chance - I mean, I don't know, you've been away, you've had your own life, you haven't kind of cared about what goes on in my life-

SHE: That's not true!

HE: Come on. Be honest. How often do we speak?

SHE: Well, how often do you call me?!

HE: Well, I tried calling you but it always felt like I was bugging you, so I backed off.

SHE: Do you know that when you call me you don't ask me a thing about my life?

HE: I ask you about work all the time

SHE: You don't ask me about my ***life***. You don't want to know about. . . my girlfriend. I ***always*** ask you about Rochelle, and about your kids, and about what's going on with you and you never ask me! What is the point in talking with you - it's like two idiot strangers talking.

HE: You know every time I try and ask about you, you always, always ... don't go there.

SHE: Try me!

HE: OK. What's going on with your life? Are you and Suzanna still together, I don't even know that! I heard you were having a bit of a problem, are you together or not, what?!

SHE: Oh boy, that's really nice, it really makes me want to talk about it.

HE: There you go.

SHE: "Are you together or what?" *(HE laughs)* "I heard you were breaking up, are you

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together or not, what?" And that implies that I just - I mean you are punishing me with everything you say!

HE: But I try and tell YOU!! You never volunteer ***anything***!

SHE: *(simply)* We're not friends. *(pause. They are both taken aback by what SHE's said)*

HE: Clearly. *(pause)*

SHE: *(sincerely)* And it's half my fault, I know . . . We're not. . . And I don't know what to do about it. *(pause)*

HE: Can't we be friends?

SHE: . . . I don't know. *(pause They're on the verge of dissolving)*

HE: They're dead. *(pause)* They're dead. It's just you and me. *(pause. They look at each other. SHE reaches out to him)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2007 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2014 National Qualifier
2017 National Qualifier
2018 National Qualifier
2019 National Qualifier
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